

“This is red.” Until the children see an apple again, they won’t be able to relate the colour red to a red ball or a red chair. But when it comes to Nimaya’s robots, generalisation automatically happens due to the way the robots are designed.

These robots are made after a lot of ergonomic planning and disability-conscious planning. “We need to look into the line of sight, colour combination, depth perception, and peripheral vision. All of these factors have to be taken into consideration too,” explains Dr Moorthy. The most interesting thing is that Nimaya’s robots are to be used along with a therapist, and not as a standalone product. This is because, for a child with autism or with multiple disabilities, one of the biggest challenges is social interaction. “We were always clear that we would never take the human out of the equation,” she says.

The devices are completely IoT based, and each system is interconnected. “When I went around talking to therapists, special educators, and counselors, I realised that they don’t have a lot of assessments.



Dr Ramya S Moorthy, Founder of Nimaya Innovations

The reason is that they are not able to handle the amount of data that comes with it,” recalls Dr Moorthy. With Nimaya’s robots, the amount of data the therapist has to enter is just literally four touches! The rest of it will be automatically handled by the system. The data then goes through different sets of algorithms and gives the output graph.

During the Covid pandemic, Nimaya Innovations pivoted to an app called GITA. GITA stands for Growth and Intelligence Tracking Application. It is a multi-lingual

application that helps parents track the milestones of children from birth until five years. It assesses a child’s growth in five different ways—psychomotor skills, social interaction, communication, self-awareness, and understanding. The best part is that it is a completely free app.

Apart from the app, the company runs its flagship products in two models. Any special school can subscribe to the devices and return the systems back later. The second model is where schools can directly buy the devices. Also, these products can be ordered from anywhere in India!

Nimaya Innovations will be going for investments in the near future. Speaking of the hiring trends, Dr Moorthy says, “Soon, we will be looking to expand our marketing team and sales team.” The company has won the ‘Best Innovation of the Year’ award from the Telangana government. Apart from that, Nimaya Innovations has earned a lot of accolades and grants so far. And surely many more are likely to come in the future!

—Aaryaa Padhyegurjar

3 RefillBot: MAKING UTILITY MANAGEMENT DEVICES SMART

RefillBot’s IoT solution makes operation scaling of smart devices easy. With compatible hardware and software supported by API, this startup has seen a 100% success rate of being deployed in 100 villages within 8 months

In spite of the immense number of offerings in the Internet-of-Things (IoT) field and inline business models, utility management still requires human intervention at one place or the other. Even



RefillBot’s solution being used in Karnataka villages